



April 10, 2026

Keri N Althoff, PhD, MPH
Department of Epidemiology
Bloomberg School of Public Health
Johns Hopkins University

Re: Letter of Support for Dr. Boniface Mutatina – 2027 Fulbright African Research Scholar Program

Dear Committee Members,

I am pleased to support Dr. Boniface Mutatina's application for the *2027 Fulbright African Research Scholar Program*. I was introduced to this collaboration through Dr. Abimereki Muzaale, a Ugandan-American surgeon-scientist who has been at Johns Hopkins School of Medicine since 2006. Our prior collaboration examined chronic kidney disease (CKD) in people with HIV in the United States and Canada ([Muzaale & Althoff et al., 2017](#)). That work seeded Dr. Muzaale's K08 career development award (K08 AG065520-01, "Perioperative and long-term outcomes following living kidney donation in older adults"). During his K08-funded time, Dr. Muzaale extended his interests into the intersection of aging and kidney disease. Dr. Mutatina's proposed project is the next step in this research arc — moving to aging with HIV in sub-Saharan Africa where the greatest number of older adults are living with HIV globally. Importantly, regionally-specific structural determinants shape health outcomes among people aging with HIV.

Dr. Mutatina's proposed systematic review and meta-analysis on structural interventions and quality of life among people aging with HIV in sub-Saharan Africa addresses an important and timely gap. The study will synthesize and, where possible, quantitatively pool, evidence to identify scalable, context-appropriate interventions that improve health outcomes for this growing older population. Critically, this is not a conventional one-time review. The proposed integration of machine-learning-supported evidence synthesis through [Ukubona LLC](#) will enable a living systematic review that can be continuously updated and fed directly into [Uganda's National Planning Authority and Ministry of Health](#) — something not feasible with traditional methods. This transforms the project from a static publication into a continuously updated, policy-relevant evidence platform. I support Dr. Mutatina's facilitation of a partnership between Johns Hopkins, Ukubona LLC, and Uganda Christian University. I am confident that with Dr. Muzaale's support, Dr. Mutatina will be successful in sustainable evidence synthesis and translation of the impacts of structural determinants and possible interventions to improve the lives of those aging with HIV in sub-Saharan Africa.

I am pleased to support Dr. Mutatina's application and to explore what mentorship and collaboration may look like should he be awarded this fellowship. I view this not as a discrete fellowship activity but as the foundation for a sustained research partnership linking HIV and aging science across the United States and sub-Saharan Africa, with potential pathways for continued comparative work beyond the fellowship period.

Sincerely,

A handwritten signature in black ink, appearing to read "Keri N Althoff".

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